NILESH SHINDE

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Indiana University Bloomington https://n-nshinde.github.io

PRIMARY AFFILIATION

Assistant Professor, O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs, Indiana University Bloomington

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

Affiliate, Ostrom Workshop, Indiana University
Affiliate, Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies (CLACS), Indiana University
Affiliate, Dhar India Studies Program, Indiana University
Affiliate, Health Economics Consortium, Indiana University
Affiliate, Environment, Society, and Sustainability Institute (ESSI), Indiana University
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Resource Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst (previous)

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Natural Resource Economics & Informatics, Virginia Tech, USA
M.Sc., Development Economics, University of Campinas (Unicamp), Brazil
B.E., Mechanical Engineering, Savitribai Phule Pune University, India

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Environmental Economics, Development Economics

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

MapBiomas Award (5th edition), 2023. For "Collective Property Rights Lead to Secondary Forest Growth in the Brazilian Amazon."
ICTAS Doctoral Research Award, Virginia Tech
Robert S. Burruss Fellowship, Virginia Tech
William J. Dann Fellowship, Virginia Tech
M.Sc. Fellowship, University of Campinas

GRANTS

External Grants

Illinois-Indiana Sea Grant, 2026. With Sampriti Sarkar.
Ronald Coase Institute Research Grant, "Clearing to Claim: The Perverse Incentives of Land Regularization in the Brazilian Amazon," 2025. With Kathryn Baragwanath.
USDA Travel Grant.
NASA Land-Cover and Land-Use Change (LCLUC) Program, Fieldwork Grant.

Internal Grants

CLACS Faculty Research Grant, Indiana University, "Rural Conflict Records in Brazil," 2026.
FADS, Indiana University, "SiCAR Land Records in Brazil," 2026–2027.

Pending

NIH R01, "Data Centers and Health Outcomes," 2026. With Elaine Hill, Isaiah Seth Bryant, and Daniel Cortez Hernandez.
NIH R21, "Sanitation, Extreme Weather, and Health," 2026. With Maranna Yoder and Drew Capone.
NIH R21, "Heat, Humidity, and Health," 2026. With Chris Callahan.

WORKING PAPERS

"Unintended Consequences of a Large Irrigation Project for Groundwater Recharge"
(with Prashikdivya Gajbhiye and Matt Woerman)
Revise and resubmit, Journal of Development Economics

"Addressing the Threat of Groundwater Depletion: Does a Command-and-Control Approach Work?"
(with Jayash Paudel and Sakshi Upadhyay)
Revise and resubmit, World Development

"Thirteenth Month of a Drought Year: Agricultural Shocks and Judicial Outcomes in India"
(with Sampriti Sarkar)
Invited submission, Journal of Development Economics special issue

"Gross External Damages of Water Pollution in the United States"
(with David A. Keiser, Daniel J. Phaneuf, Catherine L. Kling, Yongjie Ji, Tihitina Andarge, Mainul Hoque, and Yau-Huo Shr)
NBER Working Paper

"Clearing to Claim: The Perverse Incentives of Land Regularization in the Brazilian Amazon"
(with Kathryn Baragwanath)
Ronald Coase Institute Working Paper No. 14, 2026

"Forest Disease, Wildfire Risk, and Recreational Welfare: Evidence from the USA"
(with Calvin Bryan)

"Improving Environmental Outcomes Through Investments in Local Governance: Evidence from Brazil"
(with Stella Schons, Kathryn Baragwanath, Alexandre Gori Maia, and Gregory Amacher)

"Compliance Persistence and Conservation Permanence on Private Land in the Brazilian Amazon"
(with Stella Schons, Alexandre Gori Maia, and Gregory Amacher)

"Disease at the Root, Deforestation at the Edge: Cassava Epidemic and Deforestation in Uganda"
(with Neha Deopa)

"Drought-Induced Deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon"
(with Tengda Gong, Alankrita Goswami, and Mahmoud Osman)

"Hazardous Waste Sites Alter Regional Soil Chemistry: Evidence from 80,000 Soil Tests in Tennessee"
(with Sampriti Sarkar)

"The Agrarian Cost of Groundwater Depletion in India"
(with Prashikdivya Gajbhiye)

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Conflicts and Landholding Overlaps in SiCAR"
(with Kathryn Baragwanath and Ann Cao)

"Realization versus Selection: Evidence from Africa's Land Rush"

"Fire Control, Water Quality, and Human Health: Evidence from the Western USA"
(with Calvin Bryan)

PUBLICATIONS/FORTHCOMING/ACCEPTED

"Land Registration and Conflict Reduction: Evidence from the Brazilian Amazon"
(with Stella Schons, Alexandre Gori Maia, and Gregory Amacher)
Journal of Environmental Economics and Management 2027. 141: 103432.

"Primary Care, Weather, and the Missed Opportunity for Savings"
(with Maranna Yoder, Guangqing Chi, Seth Freedman, Kosali Simon, and Sonia Angell)
Health Affairs Scholar 2026. 4(9): qxag225.

"The Cold, Hard Truth: Evidence from Heterogeneous Snowpack Insulation Effect on Winter Wheat Yields in China"
(with Zhenyu Yao)
Environment and Development Economics 2026. 31(1): 41–64.

"Beyond the Canopy: How Satellite Data Detection Thresholds Influence Policy Evaluation and Deforestation Behavior"
(with Kathryn Baragwanath)
Journal of Environmental Economics and Management 2025. 134: 103219.

"The Human Well-Being Outcomes of Tree Plantations in Sub-Saharan Africa: A Reassessment of Evidence Using Longitudinal Subnational-Year Data"
(with Edouard Mensah, Ange Kakpo, and Ida Djenontin)
Forest Policy and Economics 2024. 160: 103141.

"Collective Property Rights Lead to Secondary Forest Growth in the Brazilian Amazon"
(with Kathryn Baragwanath and Ella Bayi)
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences 2023. 120(22): e2221346120.

"Incentives for Rural Households to Establish Tree Cover on Agricultural Land in Andhra Pradesh, India"
(with Stella Schons, Gregory Amacher, Kelly Cobourn, and Haripriya Gundimeda)
In Environmental Economics in Developing Countries: Issues and Challenges 2022. Routledge.

TALKS

Academic seminars: Hoover Institution, Stanford University; Indiana University Bloomington; Kansas State University; LEEP Institute, University of Exeter; Miami University (Ohio); University of Connecticut; University of Massachusetts Amherst; University of Wisconsin–Madison

Conferences: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association; Allied Social Science Associations; Association of Environmental and Resource Economists; Camp Resources; Chinese Economists Society; Heartland Workshop for Environmental and Resource Economics (University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign); NBER Environment and Energy Economics Spring Meeting; Northeast Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC); Social Cost of Water Pollution Workshop; Workshop on Environmental Economics and Data Science (TWEEDS); Virginia Tech GIS Symposium

TEACHING

Environmental Economics and Finance (SPEA-E 340, undergraduate), Indiana University Bloomington
Guest Lecturer, LEAP Executive Program, Indiana University Bloomington
Guest Lecturer, Economics of Water Policy, University of Massachusetts Amherst
Teaching Assistant, Water Policy and Economics, and Natural Resource Economics, Virginia Tech

ADVISING AND MENTORING

Ph.D. students, Indiana University Bloomington: Junying Tong (ESSI Award), Dennis Vera, Sungha Jo
Research interns, Indiana University Bloomington: Farah Vianda, Vinay Kamath, Rishikesh Kumar Stalin
Research intern, University of Massachusetts Amherst: Shreyas Mishra

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: Journal of Public Economics, Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Land Economics, Ecological Economics, Journal of Institutional Economics, Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Science

Grant reviewer: The British Academy

Conference program reviewer: AAEA, AERE, European Economic Association, Social Cost of Water Pollution Workshop

Conference co-organizer: Workshop on Integrated Assessment Models and the Social Cost of Water Pollution (with Cornell Atkinson Center for Sustainability and U.S. Environmental Protection Agency)

Member: American Economic Association; Agricultural and Applied Economics Association; Association of Environmental and Resource Economists

OTHER

Undergraduate textbook in progress: *Environmental Economics and Finance: Markets, Measurement, and Policy*

Research discussed in media (Mongabay, World Economic Forum, Hoover Daily Report, Stanford)